

A Voice in the Storm

Before you condemn that experience, listen carefully for there is a voice in every storm

Everyone who has ever encountered God for a life change will always explain of the extraordinary experience they had with the encounter. Encountering God will always be an extraordinary experience because God is such. The experience at first feels like a huge storm running over you. Either you may feel like you are walking in the opposite direction of a strong wind. This experience is as a result of you opposing the change which must occur in the presence of God. This change is about being transformed from what you have been to a new nature

Storms are just normal things changing suddenly and behaving completely in a new way. In the Biblical sources storms have been recorded to have arisen from Wind, Sea water, Lake Water, Insects (Locusts), Rain etc.

The reason behind God allowing storms over the lives of His children is to displace us from the comfort of the ordinary level and cause us to move a level up, to the extraordinary level (the level of God)

Just like what happens when you throw an object (stone) into stationary waters in a pool, it splashes all over certain and droplets take an upward trajectory. Some falls back to the same level they were and a few springs outside the pool. These are the droplets that experience new things. So God by causing such storms over your life wants you to be moved in an upward trajectory and land to a new space. Now when you become easy to land at a new space, your experience will be new with God. The problem is that majority fight with all they may have or access to go back to their zone of comfort and still continue calling God yet again!

Any storm that God has in His righteousness allowed to come over your life will always carry with it the very nature of God. (That is, GOOD). THE NATURE OF God is that **He is good all the time (Psalm 34:8 and 100:5, Nahum 1:7)**

His allowed happenings to His children serve as like a “refresh button”. A device may have been automatically installed with new features from the other end of the manufacturer but until the user has restarted it or “refreshed” it, he will continue to use the old version of the device. The updates require an action from the end of the user. Be easy to accept God’s refresh on our lives. Now because we are not easy to accept

disturbances even the ones that are necessary for our own good, God forces it on us for it is absolutely good for us and for His glory. Just in the same way you will force your daughter or son to go to school despite them feeling that it is interfering with their comfort, God is the unmatched Parent. Jesus said “**if you wicked people know how to do good things to your children what about your heavenly father, won’t He do even better to you?**” (Mathew 7:11)

Jesus watched from the righteousness of His Father and saw the disciples enjoying the comfort of anointing in Jerusalem. They were unwilling to break their comfort and go to places they had never been before to preach the gospel of the kingdom of God and salvation through Jesus Christ (as He had ordered them in Mathew). He decided to unleash a huge storm in the city and nearby towns. He started by taking one of them (Stephen) in a very scaring manner and then persecution followed against the disciples and any other convert of Jesus Christ. This made them to flee Jerusalem and moved further exterior and reaching the gentiles. It was a painful experience but many became even great and strong in the spirit and God was glorified through it. This is how gospel spread from the town of Jerusalem to Kilifi

This displacement is aimed at growing your Spirit. And the new level I am talking about is in relation to Spirit. Jesus talking to the Samaritan woman said “God is Spirit and those who worship Him must be in the Spirit” (John 4:24). He also taught that “he who is born of the flesh is flesh and he who is born of the Spirit is Spirit” (John 3:6).

The above means that unless one is transformed from being of the flesh to being of the Spirit, there is zero possibility of encountering the glory of God. We must be transformed from the dominance of the flesh to the dominance of the spirit. This is because the flesh is limited to senses of **sight, smell, touch, hearing and taste**. It also succumbs to the limitation of **time** and **space (distance)**. The Spirit is not limited to anything. Paul speaking to converts urged them to accept the transformation (**renewal**) as a necessary process to experiencing God (**verse**). Paul had already accepted it to occur on him when he let go all his possessions, career, family and profession in order to experience Jesus! (Philip3:7-11)

The process of getting transformed is not easy for the ordinary human. It triggers war from within you and sometimes from outside (the people living with you or keeping your company. why the war from

within yourself? The Flesh and the Spirit though living together are completely opposed to each other (**Read Galatians 5:17**)

They see things from different perspectives, speak different language and are submissive to different principles. They are not brothers nor sisters nor relatives whatsoever. They are neighbours who come from different homes and headed to different destinations. They are two strangers who met along the way each on a journey to different places. Soon they are parting ways. (**Ecclesiastes 12:7**)

To be in the Spirit means to ‘crucify, kill’ or totally ignore the principles, perspectives and desires of the body and living in the courage of the Spirit, which is **faith**. (**Galatians 5:16 and 5:24**)

The process of moving you to the spiritual space and making dominant the spirit over flesh is therefore expected to be turbulent (that is, full of thunderstorms and lightening and generally unusual happenings). It may feel stormy but be calm for you are safe in the hands of God. Moses turned to the sons of Israel and said to them “do not fear, be calm and watch out what the Lord will deal with the enemy. At the end you will never see them again” **Exodus 14:13**

During this process you require courage. It is this courage that will enable you to see and hear from the storm, what the enemy can neither see nor hear. It is the voice of God that is only heard by the sheep of His flock (**John 10:27**).

In addition to the courage one also must be calm for the Spirit of God is gentle. Jesus in **Mathew 11:28-30** advises us to be gentle and lowly in heart like He was and still us. To be **lowly in heart** means to put away all personal interests and allow the interest of God to take first place (**Luke 9:23 amplified Bible**)

The biggest enemy in this stage is fear. One should not allow fear to invade your heart. If it succeeds then its first work is to erode away the trust you had in God. So faith is drained away and you are taken back to the level you were. Instead of the storm paying positively it leaves you with wounds and pain. Fear is a spiritual weapon used to intimidate and defeat. God does not unleash the spirit of fear to His people but Satan will use fear and panic to scatter you and make sure you do not see anything to admire when you experience storms. Fear will steal away your concentration not to listen the voice emerging from that storm

Whatever a believer does while under the influence of fear amounts to sin against God! This is because fear drains away faith and according to **Romans 14:23**, all that a believer does outside faith is sin

In **2Timothy 1:7** assures us that God has not given to us the spirit of fear, but power, love and self-discipline. We can defeat the spirit of fear by praying. When Satan tried to inflict fear in the body of Jesus, Jesus prayed and acknowledged that despite the spirit willing to go to the cross, but the body was weary and dreading in fear. He prayed for strength and He was strengthened. You can make a similar prayer to overcome fear of this and fear of that. In the name of Jesus we triumph over fear as its witnessed in **Revelation 12:11** and taught in **John 16:33**

Knowing the damage that fear can do to His people God advised Joshua that he must have courage and not to fear for He (God) was going to be with him all the time (**Joshua 1:6 and 9**). The same words God said to Moses in **Exodus 3:12**

We demonstrate courage by trusting that, irrespective of what happens God has not forsaken us and He has not handed over to Satan and even if He has allowed Satan to touch on us, it is a good reason. We should know for sure that God is right there with us.

Daniel trusted that God was ahead of him even as they led him to the den of hungry lions. The Lord was right there with him and lions could not recognize Daniel. Meshack, Shadrack and Meshack said to the King “even if you choose to boil us in furnace we will not bow to you. God has not forsaken us. He will be with us and if He can boil then we will be boiled with Him. Otherwise we will defeat that steam together with Him” (paraphrased). Inside the furnace FOUR men were seen patrolling and chatting, it was the Presence of God!. On Mt. Moriah, the presence of God was right there with Abraham and before he could slit the throat of his son (Isaac) God spoke out. You are not forsaken and you are not forgotten. The God, whom you pray and who makes you to dream and He who orders your everyday steps is with you

The longer you take to believe and exercise these words, the longer you will wait to encounter the true purpose of God with that storm. The sooner you do, the sooner the encounter happens

When Jonah was drowned into the sea, he already knew that the happening and the storm carried the voice and presence of God. When he was swallowed by that gigantic fish, he started conversation right away with God (because he believed that the presence of God was right there with him). **Read Jonah 1:12-15 and 2:1-2**

What kind of a storm are you experiencing that has made you start disliking yourself, write yourself off, hate the people around you and probably made you to feel that God has abandoned you? Tell God “I now know that it has been You God, hear me Father, give me your strength and implement your will upon my life